

FIFA World Cup 2026

Prediction Report

Stage: Round of 32

Run date: 2026-06-28 (report created: 2026-06-26)

Headline	Value
Title pick	Argentina (19.1%)
Most likely finalists	Argentina & France
Golden Boot pick	Lionel Messi (Argentina) – proj 8.9
Teams simulated	32
Monte Carlo runs	10,000

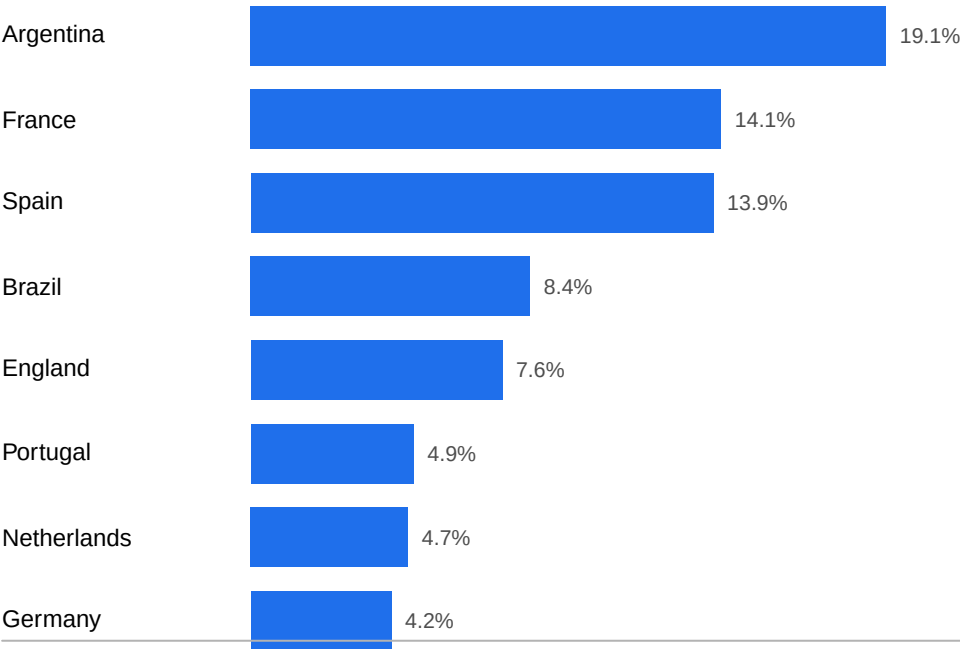
Model: ridge-shrunk Poisson (Dixon-Coles) goal model + Monte Carlo bracket simulation

Tournament Progression

As of 2026-06-28 – probabilities from 10,000 simulations

Team	R16	QF	SF	Final	Win
Argentina	87%	70%	50%	32%	19.1%
France	82%	56%	38%	24%	14.1%
Spain	80%	51%	38%	23%	13.9%
Brazil	69%	49%	29%	16%	8.4%
England	78%	50%	29%	15%	7.6%
Portugal	62%	29%	20%	10%	4.9%
Netherlands	60%	40%	19%	10%	4.7%
Germany	77%	32%	18%	9%	4.2%
USA	73%	42%	18%	9%	4.2%
Mexico	64%	31%	15%	7%	3.0%
Colombia	65%	38%	14%	6%	2.3%
Canada	68%	29%	11%	5%	1.9%
Belgium	57%	29%	11%	4%	1.8%
Morocco	40%	23%	9%	4%	1.6%
Switzerland	63%	32%	11%	4%	1.3%
Croatia	38%	14%	8%	3%	1.1%

Title-winning probability



Round of 32 – Match Predictions

Advancer = win the tie; Score = EV-optimal Scorito pick (max expected points)

Match	Tie	Advance	90'	Score	E[pts]
France v Sweden	Confirmed	France (82%)	Home win	2–0 (11%)	44
Germany v Paraguay	Confirmed	Germany (77%)	Home win	2–0 (10%)	40
Netherlands v Morocco	Confirmed	Netherlands (60%)	Home win	2–1 (9%)	30
South Africa v Canada	Confirmed	Canada (68%)	Away win	1–2 (10%)	35
Spain v Austria	Confirmed	Spain (80%)	Home win	2–0 (12%)	42
Portugal v Croatia	Confirmed	Portugal (62%)	Home win	1–0 (10%)	31
Switzerland v Algeria	Confirmed	Switzerland (62%)	Home win	2–1 (10%)	31
Colombia v Ghana	Confirmed	Colombia (64%)	Home win	1–0 (12%)	32
Brazil v Japan	Confirmed	Brazil (70%)	Home win	1–0 (10%)	35
Cote d'Ivoire v Norway	Confirmed	Norway (61%)	Away win	1–2 (9%)	30
England v DR Congo	Confirmed	England (78%)	Home win	2–0 (12%)	41
Mexico v Ecuador	Confirmed	Mexico (64%)	Home win	2–1 (10%)	33
Argentina v Cape Verde	Confirmed	Argentina (87%)	Home win	2–0 (14%)	48
Egypt v Australia	Confirmed	Egypt (51%)	Home win	1–0 (9%)	25
USA v Bosnia and Herzegovina	Confirmed	USA (73%)	Home win	2–1 (10%)	39
Belgium v Senegal	Confirmed	Belgium (55%)	Home win	2–1 (9%)	27

Top-Scorer Forecast

Projected final goals = current + expected remaining

Golden Boot projection (Proj = goals; Scorito = expected game points)

Player	Team	Now	Exp+	Proj	Scorito
Lionel Messi	Argentina	6	2.86	8.86	77.8
Kylian Mbappe	France	4	2.49	6.49	64.9
Vinicius Junior	Brazil	4	1.55	5.55	39.8
Erling Haaland	Norway	4	1.49	5.49	32.5
Ousmane Dembele	France	4	1.28	5.28	33.3
Harry Kane	England	3	2.05	5.05	51.4
Jonathan David	Canada	3	1.55	4.55	34.6
Cristiano Ronaldo	Portugal	3	1.21	4.21	29.4
Deniz Undav	Germany	3	1.16	4.16	27.1
Julian Alvarez	Argentina	2	1.68	3.68	45.8
Christian Pulisic	USA	2	1.47	3.47	34.6
Alvaro Morata	Spain	2	1.19	3.19	31.2

Scorito top-scorer picks for Round of 32 (position & stage weighted)

Player	Team	Pos	E[pts]
Alphonso Davies	Canada	DF	19.8
Lionel Messi	Argentina	FW	14.9
Kylian Mbappe	France	FW	14.9
Jamal Musiala	Germany	MF	14.3
Harry Kane	England	FW	13.4
Erling Haaland	Norway	FW	13.2
Jonathan David	Canada	FW	13
Christian Pulisic	USA	FW	11

Recommendations & Method

How to play these predictions

STRATEGY: Submit the EV-optimal score per tie (max expected Scorito points), not the bare most-likely score -- the toto term dominates, so never pick a draw when a win is favoured. For top scorers, pick by Scorito value (goals x position x stage: a defender/keeper goal pays 4x a forward's), not raw goals. Model's title pick: Argentina (19.1%, worth 250 bonus pts).

Champion pick: Argentina (19.1%). Safe R16 backers: Argentina, France, Spain, England, Germany, USA.

Methodology

1. Team strength starts from Elo priors adjusted by researched form/injury notes.
2. A Dixon-Coles bivariate Poisson model turns strength into scoreline distributions;
parameters are refined by a ridge-penalised fit on observed results (shrinking to priors).
3. A Monte Carlo simulation plays out the bracket many times -> progression probabilities,
with extra time and strength-tilted penalty shootouts for knockout ties.
4. Each team's expected goals are shared among its players (form-adjusted) and weighted by
how far the team is projected to advance -> per-stage and Golden Boot scorer forecasts.

Data provenance

Verified: group draw, reported group winners, R32 anchor ties, Golden Boot tallies.

Illustrative/projected: unplayed scores and not-yet-confirmed bracket slots.

Refresh input_data/ CSVs with official data and re-run to update everything.